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"The Indian Struggle : Questions Answered"[1]

QUESTION : National Government spokesmen here claim that the new Constitution in India is a great success, and that the acceptance of office by the Congress is proof of this. What is the opinion of the National Congress on this view ?

Answer : The acceptance of office is no proof that the Congress is going to work the Constitution for all time. The Congress Party has gone into office with considerable misgiving.

Its object in doing so is two-fold : firstly, to consolidate its own position; and secondly, to demonstrate that within the conditions of the present Constitution it is not possible to achieve anything really big or substantial. If contrary to its apprehension something substantial is achieved, then that will strengthen the political organisation of the people in their struggle for freedom.

Question : Is there any likelihood of the Congress accepting the Federal part of the Constitution ?

Answer : There is no possibility of the Congress changing its mind and agreeing to work the Federal part of the Constitution, as it did in the case of the Provinces. There is no analogy between the Provincial part and the Federal part of the Constitution.

Question : What in your view is the next stage of the national struggle ? Is it true that there is rapid development of peasant unrest and of the strike movement ?

Answer : The next stage of the national struggle will be a further growth of mass consciousness at an increasing tempo. The problem for the Congress will be to mobilise this strength and

[1] Report of an interview with R. Palme Dutt, published in the *Daily Worker*, London, January 24, 1938.